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Shortcut to run Code in Zed Editor

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I usually use VSCode and I'm used to hitting `cmd-r` to run files quickly after making small changes. Typing the whole command to compile and run the file every time isn't practical. However, when I switched to **Zed**, I missed this feature because **Zed** is a relatively new code editor and doesn't support it by default and there is no extension for it.

Solution

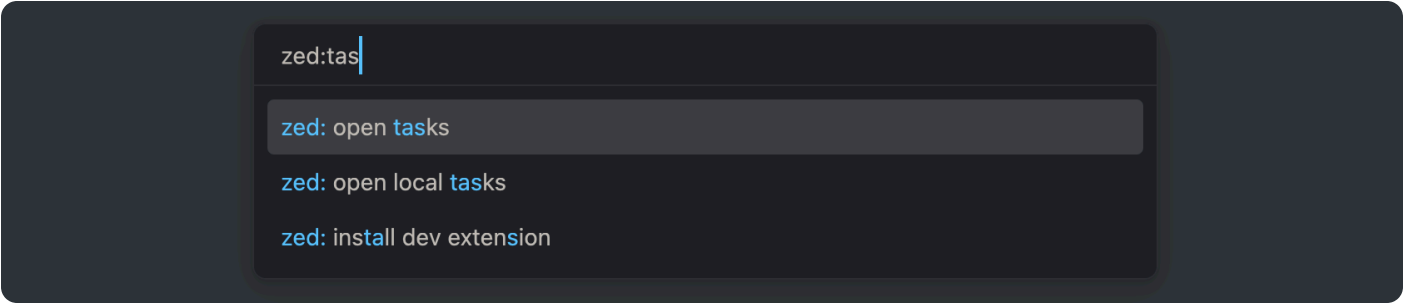
I used **tasks**, **shell scripts**, and **keymap bindings** to create a keyboard shortcut to run a code file.

When I hit the key combination, It will run the `a task` and the task will run a `shell script` that will evaluate the file type and compile and run the file accordingly.

Create a task

You can open the `tasks.json` file using the command palette (`cmd-shift-p`) or by directly editing the file at the path below:

File Path: `~/.config/zed/tasks.json`



zed:tas

zed: open tasks

zed: open local tasks

zed: install dev extension

Write the following configuration in the tasks.json file:

```
[
  {
    "label": "run file",
    "command": "sh ~/.config/zed/custom_runfile.sh",
    "description": "Compiles and runs the current code file",
    "use_new_terminal": false,
    "allow_concurrent_runs": false,
    "reveal": "always"
  }
]
```

Explanation:

The task will run the command `sh ~/.config/zed/custom_runfile.sh` whenever the task is called.

Create a Shell Script

We need to create a script that will run when the task is called. This script gets the file name that is currently open in the editor, detects the file type, and performs the necessary actions to compile and run the file.

I created the shell script in `~/.config/zed/custom_runfile.sh`, but you can create it anywhere.

Write the following code in the file:

```
#!/bin/bash
```

```
# Access the full path using ZED_FILE
full_path="$ZED_FILE"

# Extract filename with extension
filename_ext=$(basename "$full_path")

# Extract filename and extension
filename="${filename_ext%.*}"
extension="${filename_ext##*.}"

echo "[running $filename_ext]"

if [[ "$extension" == "cpp" ]]; then
    g++ "$full_path" -o "$filename" && ./"$filename";
elif [[ "$extension" == "py" ]]; then
    python3 "$full_path";
else
    echo "no"
fi
```

Currently, I have only defined the script for running **C++** and **Python** files, but you can add support for more file types in a similar way.

Keybinding

To run the task using a keyboard shortcut, we need to define it in `keymap.json`.

The `keymap.json` file can be accessed using the Zed command palette (`cmd-shift-p`) or at the path below:

File Path: `~/.config/zed/keymap.json`

zed:key

zed: open **keymap**

⌘ K ⌘ S

zed: open default **keymap**

Write the following configuration in the `keymap.json`:

```
[
  {
    "context": "Workspace",
    "bindings": {
      "cmd-r": ["task::Spawn", { "task_name": "run file" }]
    }
  }
]
```

Note: I used the `cmd-r` key combination. This will override the default action for `cmd-r`. Choose a key combination that works for you.

Restart the Zed Editor

Now you should be able to run files using the `cmd-r` command.